▶ **GENERAL ANIL CHAUHAN**
Chief of Defence Staff

STRIVING FOR JOINTNESS

At a time when the world is witnessing two major wars, India has its own set of external challenges to deal with. Speaking at the India Today Conclave, General Anil Chauhan, the Chief of Defence Staff, highlighted the rise of China, the unsettled boundary issue and Beijing's "friendship" with Pakistan as the biggest challenges before our armed forces. Both neighbours profess a friendship "as high as the Himalayas and as deep as the oceans" and are nuclear-capable. But while these challenges are predictable, noted Gen. Chauhan, the real challenge lies in the unpredictability of evolving warfare. This necessitates introducing new weapons systems, technologies, tactics, strategies and potential organisational changes. The primary goal for the Indian armed forces, thus, is to integrate the capabilities of the three services to achieve "jointness" by 2027. "There are a large number of domains in which we will be able to integrate ourselves, starting from operational logistics, intelligence, training, HR, legal...," said Gen. Chauhan, adding that the services also need to combine their capabilities in the cyberspace and knowledge domain, which would become the "bedrock for further reforms". On the recent Agni V missile test, he highlighted India's no-first-use policy and said demonstrating such capabilities will "strengthen deterrence" and "promote strategic stability in the neighbourhood". ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The rise of China, the unsettled boundary issue and Beijing's "friendship" with Pakistan are among the biggest challenges the Indian military faces today
- But what's unpredictable is the way warfare is changing. We'll have to introduce new weapons systems, technologies and and change our tactics
- The main goal for the Indian armed forces is to integrate the capabilities of the three services by 2027, which will become the foundation for further reforms



Photographs by **BANDEEP SINGH**

ON THEATRE COMMANDS

"WARFARE IS CHANGING RAPIDLY. WE'VE GOT TO CHANGE FOR THAT. UNFORTUNATELY FOR US, FOR THE PAST 77 YEARS, **ALL THE THREE SERVICES HAVE GROWN INDEPENDENTLY. BUT NOW WE THINK, MULTIDOMAIN OPERATIONS ARE A REALITY. ALL THE THREE SERVICES HAVE TO COMBINE THEIR CAPABILITIES....** JOINTNESS IS LIKE PROMOTING BONHOMIE AND REMOVING MISTRUST, WHICH EXISTED UNTIL SOMETIME BACK"

ON ENHANCING NAVAL PROWESS

"FOR US, THE HIMALAYAS HAVE BEEN PROVIDING SECURITY FOR AGES. BUT OF LATE, BECAUSE OF THE ADVANCEMENT IN TECHNOLOGY, **HIMALAYAS ARE NO LONGER AN IMPEDIMENT.... THE ONLY WAY FOR INDIA TO GROW IS TOWARDS THE SEAS.** THREATS MAY BE IN THE CONTINENTAL DOMAIN, BUT OPPORTUNITIES LIE IN THE SEAS"